

Chapter 143-4

Xu Qingzhu's heart ached, twisting painfully. She lowered her eyes. "It's really nothing. Don't overthink it. Just now, I..."

She paused, then pretended to comfort Liang Shi nonchalantly: "I was just teasing you."

Liang Shi was stunned. "What do you mean?"

"It's just..." Xu Qingzhu said as she leaned in to kiss her. "A joke, to lighten the mood."

This was utterly ridiculous.

Let alone Liang Shi—even Xu Qingzhu herself didn't believe it.

But Xu Qingzhu's own mood was already bad enough.

These past few days, she couldn't help but think about these things, falling into a strange mental loop.

At her worst moments, she even thought—maybe they should just divorce.

When she got married back then, it was to that person, not the current Liang Shi.

But once they divorced, could they get married again?

Would the current Liang Shi still be with her?

This was a question she almost didn't dare to think about, because she had even secretly shed tears over it in her office.

Although she categorized these feelings as: post-heat period sensitivity.

She had also looked up information online, which said that Omegas would feel this kind of insecurity after being marked by an Alpha, worrying that the Alpha might leave at any time.

After all, in the relationship between an Alpha and an Omega, it was the Omega who was most affected.

Whether physically or psychologically, Omegas were more dependent on Alphas. The internet said this was the influence of pheromones.

But Xu Qingzhu felt that even without pheromones, she would still be deeply affected by this.

Pheromones were just an external aid—she was psychologically, truly dependent on Liang Shi.

This dependence wasn't about needing Liang Shi to help her do things, but about fearing that she would leave.

Just like before, falling into a coma.

Although she had woken up now and had promised she wouldn't disappear like last time again.

But was what she said definitely true?

Her last disappearance was something even she herself hadn't anticipated.

For something that even Liang Shi herself didn't know about, how credible could her promise be?

Liang Shi was too calm. Although she would blush when teased in daily life, she would also blush when seeing a couple on the street doing something slightly intimate.

That was just a characteristic of hers.

It couldn't be taken as proof that she loved her.

Sometimes Xu Qingzhu felt she was too clever, too fond of observing and pursuing details.

She could clearly judge many things, like knowing that Liang Shi needed to obtain something from her.

After becoming more familiar with Liang Shi, she knew she wasn't someone with broad or refined hobbies.

Even if she was an ordinary person, Xu Qingzhu still liked her.

Yet she would take Xu Qingzhu to concerts.

That pianist, though internationally renowned, didn't have the best reputation. Xu Qingzhu actually didn't like him that much, but since Liang Shi asked, she said she did.

Then there was that time making ceramics.

Liang Shi was very serious about that kind of handicraft, but she herself wasn't particularly interested—she just did it as if completing a task.

And then there was that time playing escape room.

Xu Qingzhu was genuinely anxious. She wished she could just tell Liang Shi directly: "Whatever tasks you have to complete, tell me. I'll help you complete all of them."

But she didn't dare. She was afraid Liang Shi would retreat, afraid she would be scared.

So she could only probe gently, getting the answers she wanted through repeated probing.

Whatever Liang Shi proposed, Xu Qingzhu would never refuse.

It was all because of this.

Xu Qingzhu felt she could deceive herself for a lifetime, as long as Liang Shi remained the current Liang Shi.

Her jiejie.

She could do it.

But lately, her emotions had been increasingly on the verge of losing control. She would inexplicably think about many questions, thinking until she couldn't sleep, thinking until tears flowed. Then in the middle of the night, she would stir Liang Shi's emotions and do those things with her to calm herself down.

It was probably after going through the heat period that she had become more and more anxious about gains and losses.

One day she even had a nightmare. When she woke up and felt the empty space beside her, she was so scared she trembled. She hurriedly got up to look, but her legs buckled and she collapsed to her knees on the ground.

That day, Liang Shi had just gotten up to use the bathroom.

When Liang Shi came back and saw her collapsed on the ground, she was startled. She immediately went forward to help her up, asking what was wrong.

Only then did Xu Qingzhu belatedly realize her behavior was too absurd. She didn't dare say it was because she was afraid Liang Shi had disappeared, afraid she would feel guilty about being in a coma for so long.

So Xu Qingzhu lied: "I slept too long. My legs went numb."

Liang Shi even laughed at her: "That's something you don't see every day."¹

That day, they were reckless again.

From midnight until dawn, Xu Qingzhu's voice was hoarse from crying.

All the emotions she didn't dare to show in front of Liang Shi were released through intimacy.

At this moment, Xu Qingzhu didn't dare to stay in this space any longer. She was afraid she would start crying.

She forcefully broke free from Liang Shi's hand. "I really do have things to do. I need to go first."

But Liang Shi held onto her, pulling her into her embrace.

After a moment, Liang Shi said: "Xu Qingzhu, there won't be anyone else."

Liang Shi's voice was somewhat halting. In this still somewhat proper situation and setting, it was rather difficult to say.

But she still said firmly: "Only you."

—You are the only one, and you are special.

¹ **"That's something you don't see every day"** (活久見): A Chinese internet slang phrase that literally means "live long enough and you'll see anything." It's used to express surprise at something unusual or unexpected, similar to saying "well, that's a first" or "now I've seen everything."